

Producers, Consumers and Decomposers

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 4 Science — Biological Sciences

ACARA v9.0: AC9S4U01

Learning Intention

I am learning to explain the roles of producers, consumers and decomposers within a habitat.

Success Criteria

- I can define producer, consumer and decomposer.
- I can sort living things into these 3 roles.
- I can explain how each role helps a habitat survive.

3 Jobs in Every Habitat

Producers make their own food (plants). Consumers eat other living things (animals). Decomposers break down dead material and return nutrients to the soil (fungi, bacteria, worms).

Worked Example

Is a mushroom a producer, consumer or decomposer?

It breaks down dead leaves and wood for nutrients.

Answer: Decomposer.

Part A — Warm Up

Circle the producer: **kangaroo** **gum tree**
earthworm

True or False: Consumers make their own food using sunlight. _____

Name one decomposer you might find in a garden. _____

Part B — Core Skills

Sort into Producer, Consumer or Decomposer:

gum tree, koala, fungi, grass, dingo, earthworm

Why are producers important to every other living thing in a habitat?

What would happen if all decomposers disappeared?

Name 2 backyard consumers.

1. _____ 2. _____

Word Bank

producer • consumer • decomposer • habitat • nutrients • energy • photosynthesis • organism

Working Space — Draw a Habitat with a Producer, Consumer and Decomposer

Producers, Consumers and Decomposers — Page 2

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 4 Science — Biological Sciences

ACARA v9.0: AC9S4U01

Part C — Challenge: The Rainforest Investigation

In an Australian rainforest, a cassowary (a large flightless bird) eats fallen fruit from trees. When the cassowary's droppings land on the forest floor, fungi and bacteria break them down, releasing nutrients back into the soil for the trees to use.

Q8. Identify the producer, consumer and decomposer roles in this rainforest example.

Q9. Explain how the cassowary and the fungi both help the rainforest trees grow, even though they play very different roles.

Q10. Scientists say cassowaries are vital for spreading rainforest seeds. If cassowaries disappeared from the rainforest, predict one effect on the producers (trees and plants), and explain your reasoning.

Answer Key — Part A

A1: gum tree

A2: False — producers make their own food using sunlight; consumers eat other living things.

A3: Fungi, worms, bacteria, or similar (accept any reasonable decomposer).

Answer Key — Part B

B1: Producer: gum tree, grass. Consumer: koala, dingo. Decomposer: fungi, earthworm.

B2: Producers make their own food using sunlight, and are eaten by consumers, so they are the starting point of energy for almost every food chain in the habitat.

B3: Dead plants and animals would pile up and nutrients would not return to the soil, making it harder for producers to grow (accept similar reasonable answers).

B4: Any 2 reasonable Australian backyard consumers (e.g. birds, possums, ants, lizards) — teacher to check.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: Producer: fruit trees/plants. Consumer: cassowary. Decomposer: fungi and bacteria.

C9: The cassowary spreads seeds and returns nutrients through droppings, while the fungi break down those droppings into nutrients the trees can absorb — both help trees grow, just through different roles.

C10: Fewer seeds would be spread around the rainforest, so fewer new trees and plants might grow in new areas over time, reducing the number of producers in parts of the rainforest (accept similar reasonable predictions).

I Can Checklist

☐ I can define producer, consumer and decomposer.

☐ I can explain why each role matters.

☐ I can sort living things into these roles.